the Erragudi edict in the Anantapur district of Andhra Pradesh is engraved. Some are more difficult of access, such as the inscribed slab at Sasaram, which is located on top of the hill in the Rohtas district of Bihar; and the one at Palkigundu in the Koppal district of Karnataka, which crowns a high and fairly inaccessible ridge, can only be reached after negotiating a very steep elevation. The reasons for inscribing rocks in places that appear today to be rather remote from ancient habitations will be explored; for the moment it is the act of engraving messages on such surfaces that gives us pause.



Fig. 6.1: The Rajula Mandagiri edict is engraved on the flat rock in the foreground, in front of the tree dominating a waterbody, with a temple behind it